Agent engineering: planning, multi-agent, evals and guardrails: review



AI agents · University · Unit check

In this unit

- Plans and memory
- Several agents, one job
- Measuring an agent
- Fine-tuning and guardrails

The big ideas

- Each step builds on the last: check results, and budget the window
- One part proposes, another checks: rules first, people for actions
- A fixed, held-out test set, scored exactly, re-run after every change
- Learned safety can fail: guard actions in code, in layers

Activity: Agent design review

1. Warm-up (3 min): One idea from each lesson.
2. Design (8 min): Sketch an agent for a real university task.
3. Review (7 min): A partner checks memory, roles, tests, guards.
4. Share (2 min): The weakest point you found.

Use made-up names and data in every design. The point is the review, not a perfect agent.

Let’s discuss

1. Which idea from this unit changes how you would build an agent?
2. What would convince you that an agent is ready for real users?
3. Which guard would you add first to an AI tool you already use?

Exit ticket

- My most useful idea from this unit + the project I will use it in.